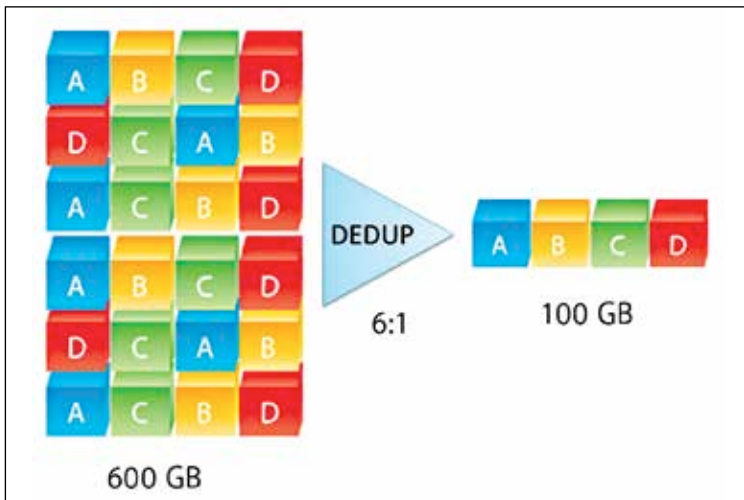


► Compress

This brings us back to the major problem with backing up data – sheer size. Sometimes the hard disk you possess doesn't have enough capacity to hold all the data that you need to back up, and sometimes bandwidth might pose as a barrier for backing up huge amounts of data. That's where compression comes in. So wait, what is compression? Compression is basically just reducing the size of a particular file which can again be expanded back into its fully functional form. Now, it might seem quite mysterious how these bits and bytes of data that were cut down can regain their original state later. Well, the basic idea is fairly simple really. Most computer files are fairly redundant in the sense that they have the same information listed over



Deduplication frees up a lot of space

and over. What compression software does is it gets rid of this redundancy, lists a piece of information only once and refers back to it over and over again whenever it appears in the original program. To make it clearer, let's consider the statement "I think therefore I am". So if we assigned numbers to the words like this:

1. I
2. Think
3. Therefore
4. Am